Heartologies Design Studio



SHORE THING

RULE BOOK

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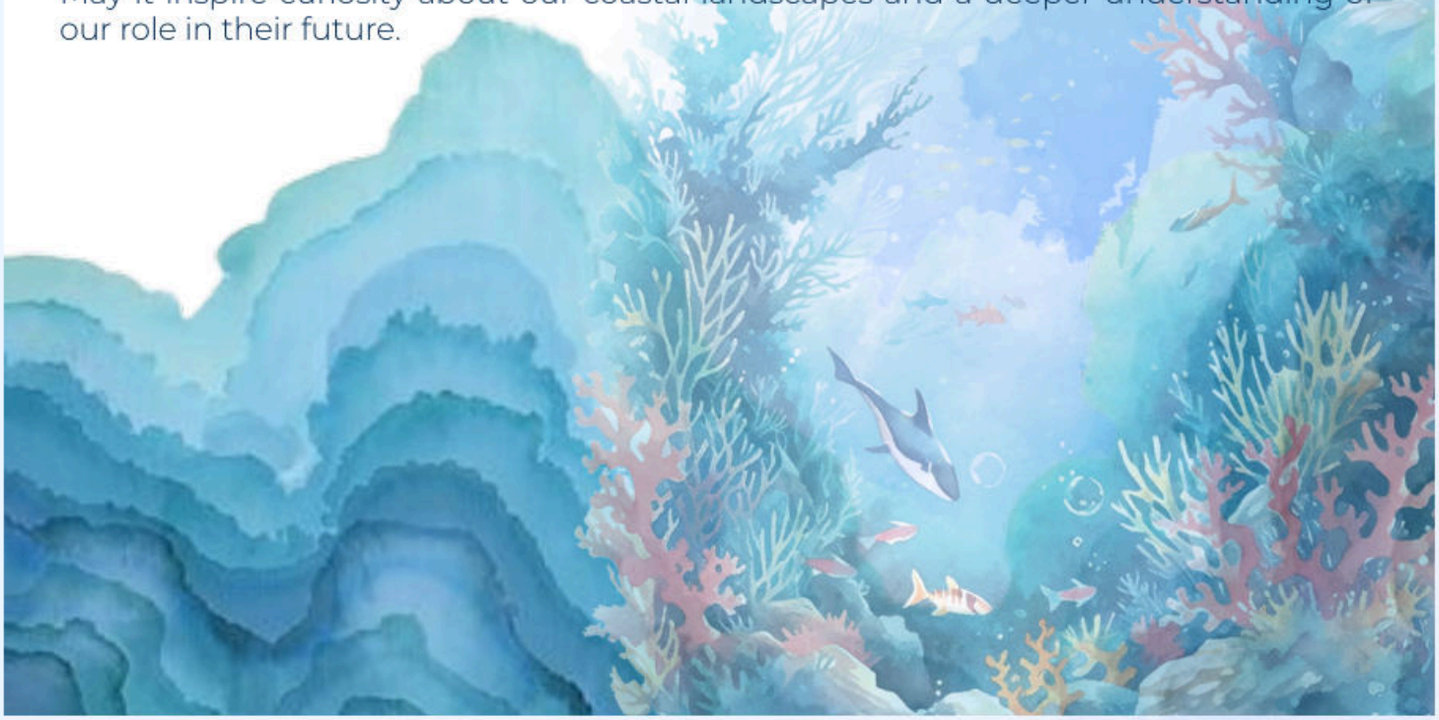
RULE BOOK

Welcome to Shore Thing, a game that invites you to experience the dynamic world of barrier beaches—those ever-shifting sandy shores that buffer coastlines, support diverse ecosystems, and, over time, adapt to the forces of nature and climate change. Shore Thing draws inspiration from the natural erosion and migration of barrier beaches, where waves steadily move sand shoreward, creating a gradual but inevitable inland shift. This process, while slow, is an essential response to rising sea levels, reshaping shorelines over centuries.

In Shore Thing, players take on the roles of coastal stewards, navigating their game pieces from the "old shoreline" to the "new shoreline" with each turn. This movement represents the gradual inland migration of beaches under the pressures of climate change. Through each round, you'll face choices that reflect the impact of environmental changes on these vital landscapes.

Designed for players ages 10 and up, Shore Thing is a journey through themes of inevitability, acceptance, and action—understanding that change is constant, yet within each of us lies the power to adapt and respond. Each round takes about ten minutes, making it a quick and engaging activity for classrooms, family game nights, or even solo play. Younger players might enjoy the game most with a caregiver's guidance, while older players can explore the game's deeper themes independently or in discussion with others.
So gather your pieces and prepare to navigate the shifting sands of Shore Thing!

May it inspire curiosity about our coastal landscapes and a deeper understanding of our role in their future.



Setting
RULE BOOK

Each **location** chosen for Shore Thing reflects unique challenges and characteristics that shape its barrier beaches and the surrounding ecosystems. These coastal areas not only highlight the beauty of sandy shorelines but also the impacts of climate change, erosion, and human intervention. Here's a look at each location and the specific issues its shores face:

PLAYBOARD 1: Rhode Island, USA

Rhode Island's coastline, particularly its barrier beaches along the southern shore, faces significant risks from rising sea levels and increasingly severe storms.

PLAYBOARD 2: Georgia, USA

Georgia's barrier islands, such as Cumberland and Sapelo, form an intricate part of the southeastern U.S. coastline. These islands, with their wide, sandy beaches and extensive salt marshes, play a key role in supporting diverse ecosystems and act as a natural defense against storm surges.

PLAYBOARD 3: Mar De Plata, Argentina

Argentina's eastern coast, particularly around the Buenos Aires province, includes sandy barrier beaches like those in Mar Chiquita, a unique biosphere reserve.

PLAYBOARD 4: South Coast, Jamaica

Jamaica's southern coastline, including areas such as Treasure Beach and the Great Pedro Bay, is known for its beautiful but fragile barrier beaches. These sandy shores are particularly sensitive to erosion caused by storms, rising sea levels, and coral reef degradation.



Game Modes

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Cooperative Mode

The default mode of Shore Thing is cooperative, reflecting the shared responsibility we all have to address climate-related challenges and care for our natural ecosystems. In this mode, players work together to achieve shared goals, pooling their knowledge and resources to overcome the environmental obstacles presented in the game. By collaborating, players learn that successful stewardship of coastal environments requires teamwork, strategy, and collective effort.



Facilitated Mode

For young players or those who would benefit from additional guidance, Shore Thing can be played in a Facilitated Mode. Here, a facilitator joins the game to prompt discussion, assist with gameplay activities like moving pieces and interpreting rules, and help players draw meaningful connections between the game mechanics and real-world environmental issues. The facilitator's role is to create an engaging, supportive atmosphere, encouraging players to think critically about the impacts of climate change and to reflect on their role in conservation.



Core Gameplay

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Game Objective

In Shore Thing, players team up to simulate the natural migration of a barrier beach by moving all pieces from the "old shoreline" to the "new shoreline." Throughout this journey, players take on tasks like restoring habitats and rescuing endangered or threatened creatures, aiming to make careful moves to protect as much of the ecosystem as possible. The goal is to manage the shoreline's inevitable migration while minimizing the impact on wildlife and coastal habitats. Along the way, players will also work to keep the beach and ocean clean by removing trash, underscoring the role of conservation in coastal environments.



MORE THAN WINNING

Its about preserving, understanding, and reflecting on coastal ecosystems.

Core Mechanism

Players take turns moving pieces from their current position on the old shoreline to a new spot on the new shoreline. Each turn begins by rolling two dice, which generates a number linked to an "EVENT"—a simulated environmental factor or occurrence that affects coastal movement. These events bring realistic challenges, requiring players to adapt strategies to keep the migration smooth while protecting habitats and maintaining a healthy beach ecosystem.



Core Gameplay

RULE BOOK

Duration

Each round of Shore Thing is designed to be brief, lasting around 10 minutes. A full session, which includes multiple rounds, typically lasts between 30 and 45 minutes, making it an ideal activity for group settings or classroom use.

Number of Players

The game can be played solo or with up to 5 players, accommodating both individual play and small groups for a cooperative, interactive experience.

Turn Structure

Play moves clockwise around the table, with each player taking turns to roll the dice, trigger events, and help manage the beach migration.

The game's default mode is cooperative, encouraging friends to tackle coastal challenges together. As a team, players protect habitats, keep the beach clean, and adapt to the dynamic shoreline changes





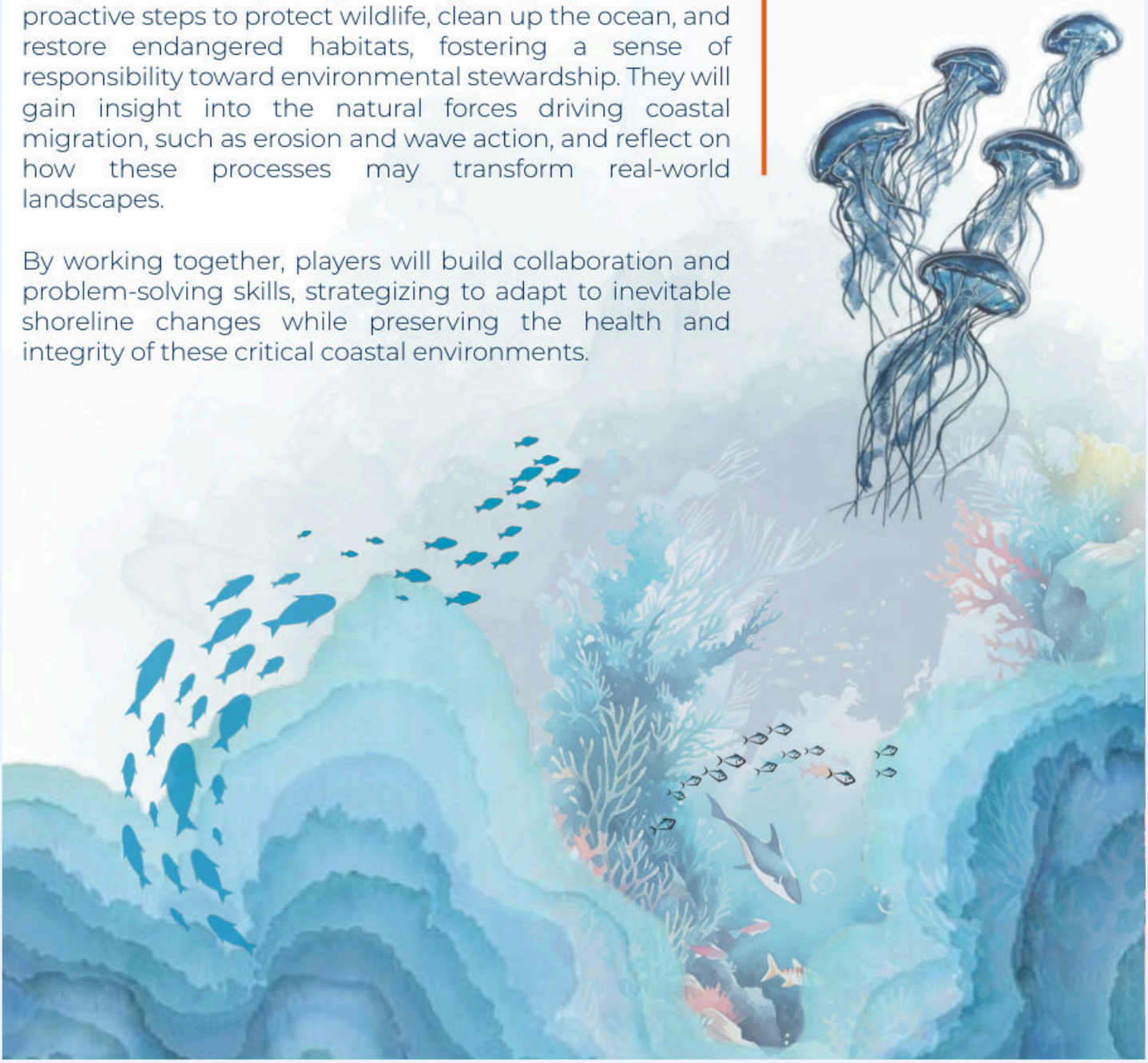
Learning Goals

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In Shore Thing, players will explore the future impact of sea level rise on coastline migration, discovering how these shifts will disrupt and reshape coastal habitats and ecosystems. As they navigate the game, players will take proactive steps to protect wildlife, clean up the ocean, and restore endangered habitats, fostering a sense of responsibility toward environmental stewardship. They will gain insight into the natural forces driving coastal migration, such as erosion and wave action, and reflect on how these processes may transform real-world landscapes.

By working together, players will build collaboration and problem-solving skills, strategizing to adapt to inevitable shoreline changes while preserving the health and integrity of these critical coastal environments.

Understanding our oceans transformations



Setting Up
RULE BOOK

RIDE THE WAVES & BEGIN

With our shoreline set and critters in place, we're ready to shape our starting coast.

Start by opening the box and setting out the beach and critter game pieces, dice, and game cards. Find a level surface—a table, desk, or the floor—where everyone can comfortably reach the pieces. Choose the board location you'd like to play on, then select your pieces and critters native to that environment. Slot the critter pieces into the shore areas to prepare for gameplay.

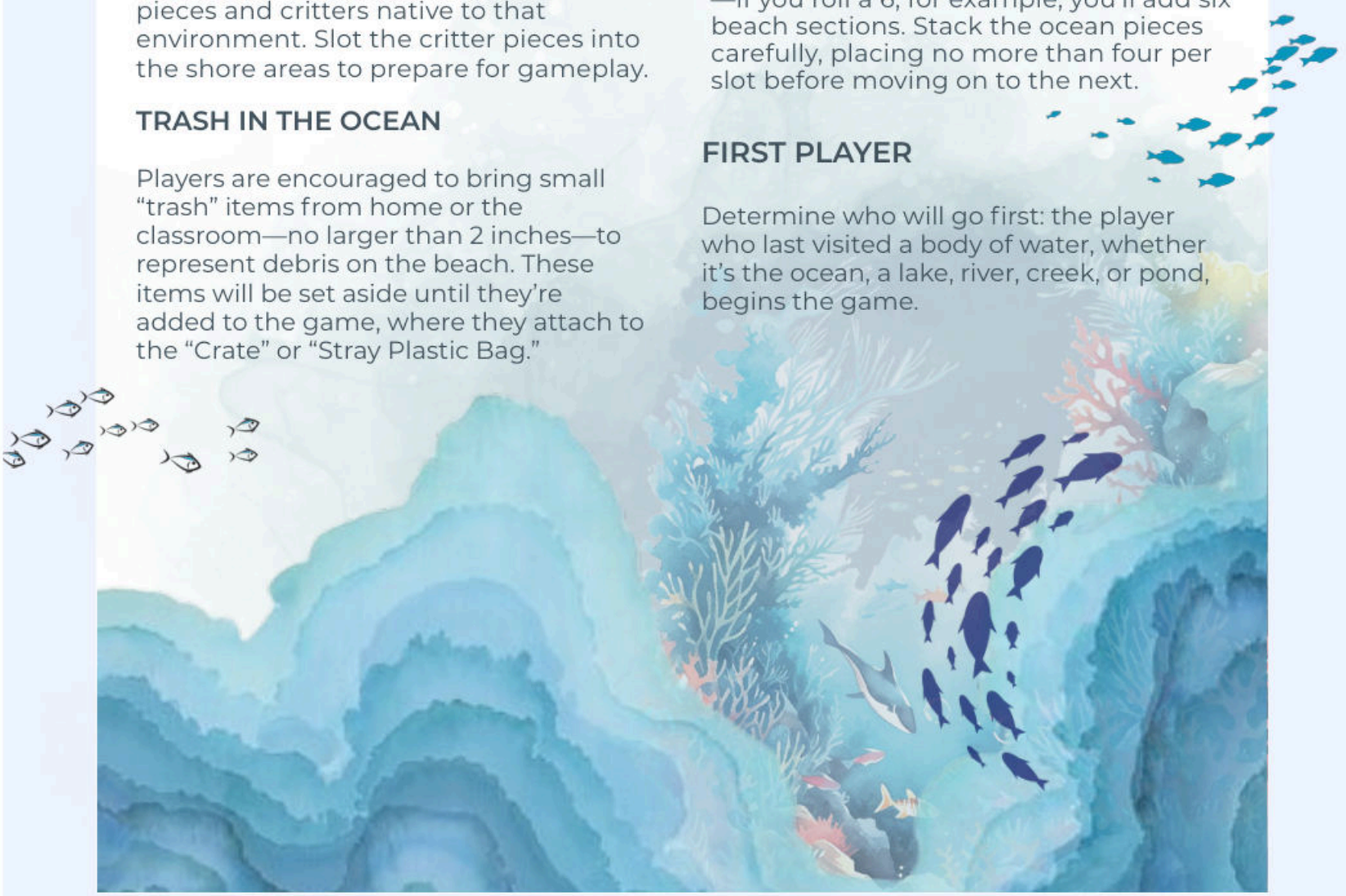
TRASH IN THE OCEAN

Players are encouraged to bring small "trash" items from home or the classroom—no larger than 2 inches—to represent debris on the beach. These items will be set aside until they're added to the game, where they attach to the "Crate" or "Stray Plastic Bag."

Begin the shoreline migration by placing one piece of the shoreline on the "new shoreline" footprint. This marks the start of the beach movement, which will continue throughout the game. To set up the starting shore, roll the dice to determine how many beach pieces to add —if you roll a 6, for example, you'll add six beach sections. Stack the ocean pieces carefully, placing no more than four per slot before moving on to the next.

FIRST PLAYER

Determine who will go first: the player who last visited a body of water, whether it's the ocean, a lake, river, creek, or pond, begins the game.



Components

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Component	Quantity	Details
Board	2	Double-sided, unique barrier beach locations
Beach Pieces (Water)	30	Represents moving shoreline waters
Habitat Pieces	15	3 Corals, 6 Salt Marshes, 3 Mangroves, 3 Seagrasses
Critter Pieces	6	1 Plankton, 1 Coral, 1 Crab, 1 Fish, 1 Turtle, 1 Seal
Dice	2	Used for determining game events
Trash Containers	4	2 Floating Crates, 2 Plastic Bags
Player-Contributed:		
Trash	6	Small player-contributed items to represent trash



How to Play

RULE BOOK

THE MIGRATION HAS BEGUN

Use the dice to determine what event has occured to affect the shore's movement

START OF TURN

On your turn, roll two dice and add the numbers to determine the event that has occurred. For example, if you roll a two and a six, you will refer to Event 8. If the event requires moving a piece from the old shoreline to the new shoreline, you may remove it from any part of the old shoreline. However, if the piece you move disrupts a habitat piece, knocking it out of the beach structure, that habitat piece is lost and removed from play.

Each new piece on the shoreline must touch an existing piece in the structure. If you draw a critter piece, place it into an appropriately sized hole in the new shoreline. If no space fits the critter piece, it is discarded from the ecosystem.

EVENT GUIDE

- 2-5 Thermal Expansion
- 6-8 Sea level rises.
- 9 Ice Cap Melting
- 10 Trash
- 11 Hurricane
- 12 Habitat Restoration



How to Play

RULE BOOK

EVENT GUIDE

2-5 Thermal Expansion— Rising sea level. Move two ocean pieces to the new shoreline.

6-8 Sea level rises— Rising sea level. Move two ocean pieces to the new shoreline

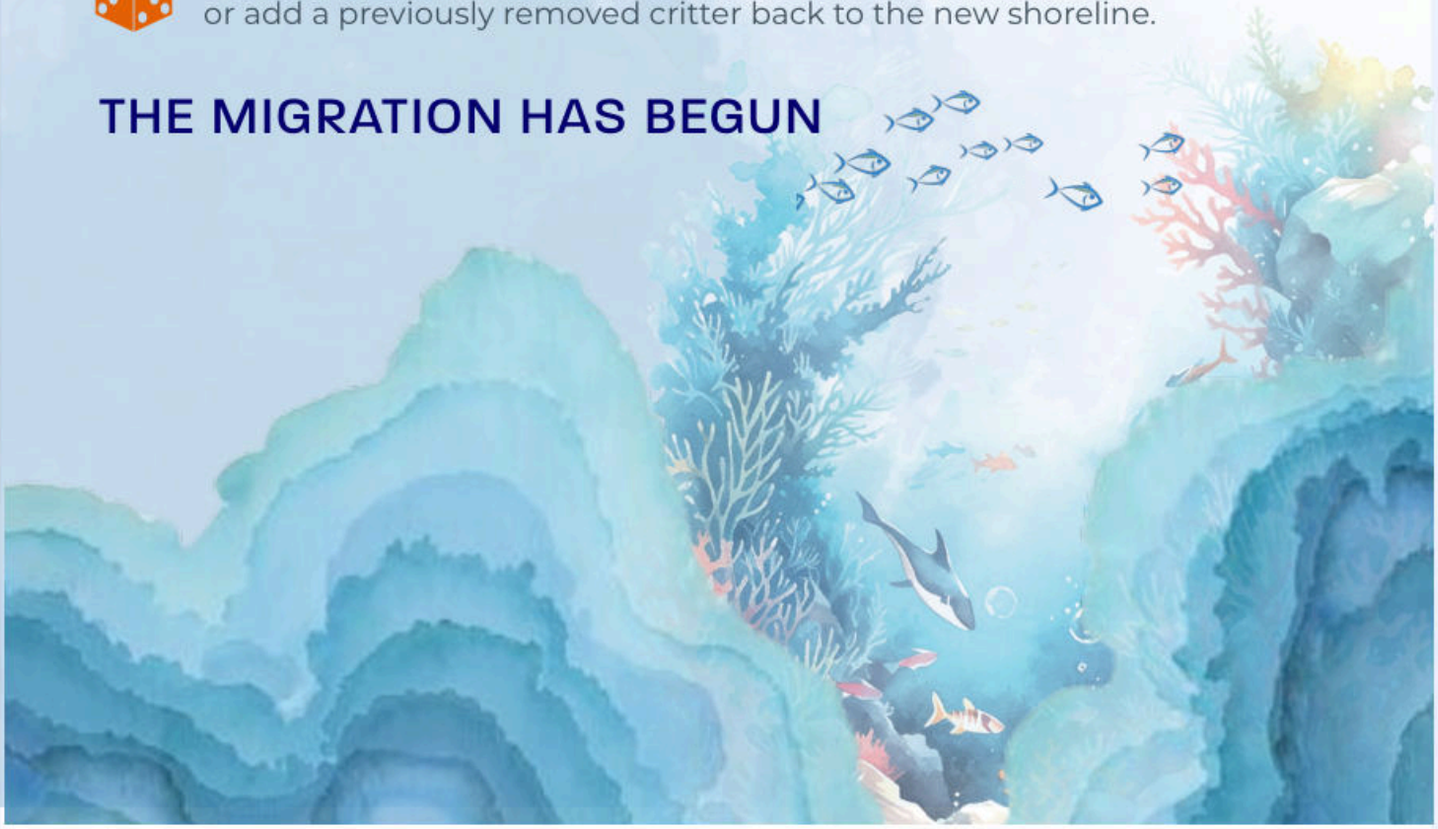
9 Ice Cap Melting— Rising sea level. Move one ocean piece to the new shoreline.

10 Trash — Place one of the group's trash tokens on the new shoreline.

11 Hurricane — Move two pieces from the old shoreline to the new shoreline, then return a piece from the new shoreline back to the old one. If the seal critter is in play, remove it from the board.

12 Habitat Restoration-— Remove one trash token from the new shoreline or add a previously removed critter back to the new shoreline.

THE MIGRATION HAS BEGUN




"With every drop of water you drink, every breath you take, you're connected to the sea. No matter where on Earth you live."
— Sylvia Earle
Heartologies Design Studio
SHORE